ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY + FINAL HSC CHECKLIST

The long-run test of policy success

A ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY

DEFINITION

Growth that protects the environment and supports future living standards.



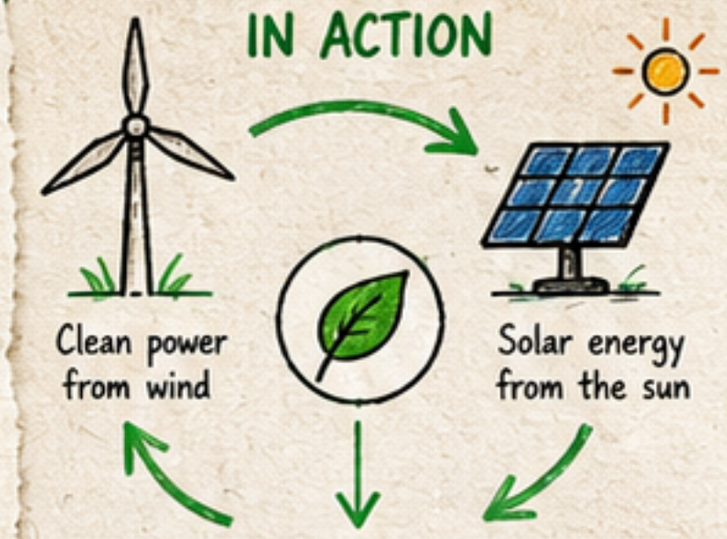
POLICY EXAMPLES

- Renewable energy investment
- Emissions-reduction policy
- Safeguard mechanism
- Energy transition / clean infrastructure

KEY INDICATORS

- Renewables were **36%** of Australia's electricity generation in 2024.
- Emissions fell in the year to June 2025, but more cuts are needed to meet Australia's 2035 target of **62–70%** below 2005 levels.

GREEN ENERGY IN ACTION



VERDICT

IMPROVING, BUT INCOMPLETE

The transition is moving forward, but faster progress is still needed.

CURRENT SCOREBOARD

How well are we meeting the HSC objectives?

1	Price stability (low, stable inflation)	PARTIAL
2	Full employment (low unemployment + strong participation)	BROADLY SUCCESSFUL
3	Growth + quality of life (strong growth + rising real GDP per capita)	MIXED
4	External stability (manageable current account + international liabilities)	MANAGEABLE/ MIXED
5	Distribution of income (fairness / equity)	PARTIAL
6	Environmental sustainability (protects environment + future living standards)	IMPROVING / PARTIAL

HSC PARAGRAPH CHECKLIST

Use this every time you evaluate a policy.

1. **DEFINE THE OBJECTIVE**
   State the objective clearly and explain why it is important.
2. **IDENTIFY THE POLICY**
   Name the policy and when/why it was introduced.
3. **QUOTE CURRENT DATA**
   Use up-to-date statistics and sources to show what is happening.
4. **EXPLAIN HOW THE POLICY WORKS**
   Link the policy to the objective using the economic mechanism.
5. **DISCUSS TIME LAGS & TRADE-OFFS**
   Consider short vs long run, side effects and opportunity costs.
6. **MAKE A FINAL JUDGEMENT**
   State how successful the policy has been overall and suggest what could be improved.

THE BEST HSC EVALUATION IS BALANCED: USE EVIDENCE, EXPLAIN THE MECHANISM, AND MAKE A CLEAR JUDGEMENT.